

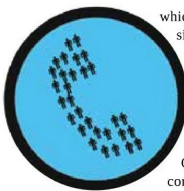
successful, and clinical trials are likely to begin this year.

The open twist: Access4Kids includes three force-sensitive resistors that measure pressure from physical movements and converts them into fine-motor gestures that translate to touch screen commands. The open source software library developed by the team is a critical component of the system, as it enables the kids to access popular applications like Facebook and YouTube, as well as custom-made apps for therapy and education.

A tool that converts missed calls into signatures on a petition

<https://github.com/mbelinsky/Crowdring>

During the famous Lokpal Bill protests by Anna Hazare in 2011, he invited people to join the movement by placing 'missed calls' to a local number, since missed calls cost nothing. In two weeks, supporters placed over 35 million calls. What a brilliant idea to garner public votes! However, the experiment was not sustainable, due to the lack of a proper digital platform for data aggregation, list cutting, and purchase of local numbers. A group of technologists and activists from New York, India, Brazil and Kenya, have partnered with ThoughtWorks to design and develop a mobile petition tool called /Crowdring,



which turns free missed calls into signatures on a petition.

The open twist: /Crowdring is inexpensive and easy. It does not require an app or even phone credit to use, and can work on any phone. After all, it is just a missed call. /Crowdring facilitates two-way correspondence that is free for the user, and can be scaled across cities and continents. It is open source and available for anyone to tweak, hack and share. To start with, activists launch a campaign, place a request on /Crowdring and register some local numbers. Then, they place an ad or share the request with the public through other means. Thereafter, all missed calls to the local number are recorded, replied to with thanks, and registered as the equivalent to signatures on a petition. **END** 

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